SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, COUNTY OF EXAMPLETON
DEPARTMENT 17
HON. IMOGEN A. PLACEHOLDER
STANDING ORDER ON CIVIL DISCOVERY AND COURTROOM PROCEDURES
(Revised August 3, 2026)

FICTIONAL DOCUMENT FOR TESTING ROGBUSTER. NOT A REAL COURT RULE OR ORDER.

The following procedures apply to all civil cases assigned to Department 17 for all purposes. Counsel are expected to read this order in full.

1. Communication with chambers

Counsel shall not contact chambers by telephone except to schedule hearings. Questions about procedure should be directed to the courtroom clerk by email.

2. Trial setting

Trial dates are set at the initial case management conference. Requests to continue trial must be made by noticed motion supported by a declaration.

3. Boilerplate objections

Boilerplate objections, including objections that a request is "overbroad, unduly burdensome, vague and ambiguous" without explanation, are improper. Any objection not stated with particularity will be deemed waived for purposes of a motion to compel.

4. Answers "subject to" objections

A party that answers "subject to" or "without waiving" its objections must state expressly whether any information or document is being withheld on the basis of those objections, and if so, which objection.

5. Contention interrogatories

The court will not sustain an objection that a contention interrogatory is "premature." A party must respond with all facts presently known to it and must supplement as discovery proceeds.

6. Requests for admission

A party that responds to a request for admission by claiming lack of information or knowledge must state in the response the reasonable inquiry it made, including the persons consulted and documents reviewed.

7. Meet and confer

Meet-and-confer letters must identify each disputed request by number and state the specific further response sought. After the exchange of letters, lead counsel must confer by telephone or videoconference before requesting an informal discovery conference.

8. Informal discovery conference

Department 17 participates in the informal discovery conference program. No motion to compel may be filed until the parties have attended an informal discovery conference. Requests are made by joint email to the clerk, attaching a joint statement of no more than three pages.

9. Supplemental responses

Where a party agrees during meet and confer to supplement a response, the supplemental response shall be served within 15 days of the agreement unless the parties agree otherwise in writing.

10. Exhibits at trial

Exhibits shall be pre-marked and exchanged no later than five court days before the final status conference.

IT IS SO ORDERED.

Dated: August 3, 2026

HON. IMOGEN A. PLACEHOLDER
Judge of the Superior Court